



levelUp

A COLLECTION OF PRO TIPS FOR EVERYTHING. Without being limited to a particular topic, these tips are from popular software, to coding, to browsers, search, storage rules, password rules, mobile device hacks, bios cracking, tweaks explained and everything tech under the sun.

How to get the minimalist Stock Android look on any smartphone

The minimalist, bloatware-free approach of Stock Android is revered by many avid Android lovers. Here's a step-by-step guide on how to get your smartphone from other manufacturers to look the part.

STOCK ANDROID has always been considered as the ideal state by the purists. Custom UIs on smartphones come loaded with features but their utility is questionable. The bloatware typically slows down the phone and consumes more battery life. The vanilla approach adopted by Google in their Pixel devices, and previously Nexus lineup, have been a highly sought-after commodity in the smartphone market. The redesigned layout of the Pixel 2's home screen, as well as the 'At A Glance' calendar widget, adds functionality and elegance to the phone which is desired by a significant amount of users. The Google phones are no longer what we can call 'pocket-friendly'. Many have resorted to rooting their device and obtaining their desired look, however, this is not an option everyone is willing to try. Users desiring the highly coveted 'Stock Android' experience can get it using just the right combination of third party applications, as well as changing the settings on their devices. Here is how it can be done.

1 INSTALLING THE RIGHT LAUNCHER:

The Pixel Launcher will be able to provide you with the closest Stock Android look and feel, essentially google-ify your phone's core aesthetic. You are going to have to sideload the Pixel Launcher on your phone as it is exclusive to Pixel devices only on the Play Store.

The Method: First, you are going to have to allow the phone to download apks from unknown sources since it is not available on the Play Store for non-Pixel de-



It doesn't get more Stock Android than the Pixel Launcher.

vices. Go to Settings, select Security and then turn on 'Unknown Sources'. Download the Pixel Launcher's APK from apkmirror (<https://digit.in/pixellauncher>). Install the apk onto your phone. Lastly,

hit the home button on your device after the installation is complete. This will make the Pixel Launcher your new default launcher.

Tip: If you are against sideloading apps/ downloading apks from unknown sources, you can use Nova Launcher and customize it to Google settings or the Google Home Launcher.

2 GET THE GOOGLE DIALER LOOK-ALIKE:

The dialer is one of the most frequently used apps on a smartphone. Google does not provide its stock dialer app on the Play Store so we will need to resort to a third-party look-alike which comes very close to the original: exDialer.

The Method: Head over to the Play Store, find and install exDialer. Once it has installed, go to 'Settings' on your phone and find 'Apps'. Go to default apps and set exDialer as your default dialer/calling app.

Take it one step ahead and disable your stock contacts/calling app on your

smartphone by finding it in 'Apps' in your phone Settings and clicking on 'Disable' once you're there.



ExDialer comes astoundingly close to Google's native dialer and is free to download.

3 CHANGE YOUR MESSAGING APP:

Android Messages has proven to be one of the most popular, easy-to-use messaging apps across all platforms. It also sports a handy function where you can swipe the messages you deem unimportant away, only to have them return when the person texts again.

The Method: Head to the Play Store and download the 'Android Messages' app. Avoid confusing it with duplicates by looking for Google



Simple, aesthetic and beautiful: Android Messages gets you closer to the Stock Android look